

T. NAGAR

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Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamallee » Chetpet

‘Key junction in Nungambakkam needs better regulation’

V. RENUKA

The intersection of Choolaimedu High Road and Nelson Manickam Road around the subway near Loyola College in Nungambakkam is known for traffic congestion during peak hours, especially in the evening. On a recent evening, utter chaos prevailed at the junction. A lone traffic police personnel was

regulating the junction and he was clearly at sea while trying to restore order at the spot. Given the importance of the junction, the authorities concerned are requested to do the needful such as deploying adequate number of traffic police personnel and improving the traffic signal coordination. Such measures will ensure hassle-free traffic flow.

*V. Renuka is a resident of
Nungambakkam*



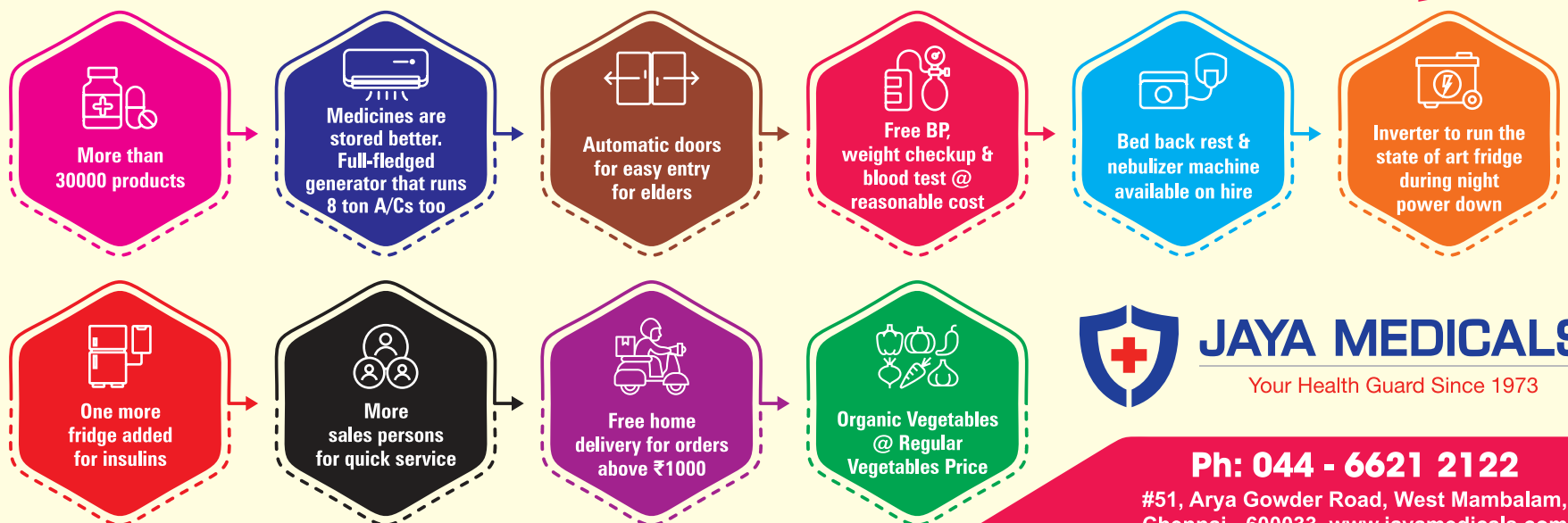
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எங்கள் திருநாட்டில் !

ஆட்சி மாற்றத்தை ஆவலோடு எதிர்பார்த்துக் காத்துக்கொண்டிருக்கும் தமிழக மக்களே!

தியாகராய நகர் (தி.நகர்) சட்டமன்றத் தொகுதி

ஒருங்கிணைந்த வளர்ச்சி தேர்தல் அறிக்கை 2026

எங்கள் நல்லாட்சியே !

* **மேலக்குறையத்து மற்றும் சாணை மேலாணையம்**
 திருநெல்வேலி மாவட்டத்திலுள்ள ஒழுங்கான, பாதுகாப்பான தொகுதியாக மாற்ற: பாதுகாப்பு வலம் வலம் வலம் வலம் வலம், அடுக்குமாடி வசதி நிறுவனம், நவீன (சமூக) சிமன்ட், சாணைமேலாணை நிறுவனம் (மார்க்கெட்) கட்டுப்பாடு ஆகியவை ஏற்படுத்தப்படும்.

- மதுரை நகராட்சி வாரியகம் மற்றும் நீர் தேக்கத்தை தடுக்க நிர்ணயிக்கிறது

மதுரை காணத்தின் நீர் தேக்கம் இயல்பான நிலைமை. உருவாகக் கூடியதாக முன் வராமல் கத்தல், அளவடி ஏற்படும் இடங்களில் மீதமுள்ள நீர் உடனடி நடவடிக்கைகள் எடுத்த அமைச்சரவரின்

• குறுநீர் மற்றும் கடுங்குநீர் போகாவிட்டால்
தொகுதியில் 24X7 குறுநீர் விநியோக மாதிரி மற்றும் தூக்கநிலை குறுநீர் சேதங்களை கண்காணிப்புக் குழு கொண்டுவர வேண்டுகிறார்.

சுபிரியத் தகதிரிப்பு திறன் மேம்பாடு மற்றும் வணிக வளாகங்களிலிருந்து மதுவழிநீர் பயன்பாடு ஊக்குவிக்கப்படும்.

● **குடிசை மேலாண்மை மற்றும் பொதுக் களங்கள்**

குடிசை இலக்கு கதிராசை பகுதியை ௧. குளக்கேட்டு குப்பைப்பகுதி மற்றும் பிறிதேட்டு, வணிகப் பகுதியைப்போல தனி கேடிரைட்டேரே, டீட்டிட்டு வணிகபகுதி கேடிரைட்டேரே ஆகவாங்கும், ஈரக்குப்பைப்பகுதி ௨.காங்கு மற்றும் சபையம் மற்றும் கொத்துக் கதிர்வி. மேல்பாடு ௩. காங்குப்பேட்டி

• திருநகர் சந்தை (பலகாரி) பகுதி சிறப்பு திட்டம்

[illegible]

கல்வித் திறன் வளர்ச்சிக்கு: அரசு பள்ளிகளில் சிறப்பு வகுப்புகள், திறன் மேம்பாட்டுப் பயிற்சிகள் மற்றும் UPSC / TNPSC ஆகிய தேர்வுகளுக்கு இவ்வளவு பயிற்சி அமையக்கூட, மாணவர்களின் மேல் அடிப்படை நிதிஉதவி மற்றும் வட்டம் வாரியாக நூலகங்கள் அமைக்கப்படும்.

• **கற்றுச்சூழல் மற்றும் பாலவளத்திப்பங்கள்**
பகைமையான, ஐயமையான கற்றுச்சூழல் அமைத்திட்ட வட்டியங்கள் தோறும் சிறிய பூங்காக்கள், திறந்த விவசாயப்பாடு அமைதானங்கள், பாதுகாத்தோட்ட திட்டங்கள், பாதுகாத்தோடு கோரிக்கை

நெடுயில் (யோசாஸ்கு) மறுபுறமிருக்க, ABC எலிக்குறையில் தெருவாய் போவானைப் பற்றும் தொகுதியில் உள்ள சமுதாய நலக்கூட்டுகள் அனைத்தும் அரசியல் தலைவரே இல்லாமல் முறையாக குறைந்தக் கட்டணத்தில் பதிலே செய்யப்படுகின்றன.

* போலந்தியிலிருந்து தப்பியு வந்தவர்கள் அனைவரும்
பாதுகாப்பு

எனவே, எந்தெந்த அமைப்புகளும் மறுபுறம் மறுபுறமே இன்னமும் உயர்வாகியிருக்கும். மதினன் (ஹான்சு) உயர்வாகியிருக்கும் கருவியை அமைத்து போனாப்போலும் இன்ன வகையில் உருவாக்கப்படும்.

• **நிதி திட்டங்கள்:**
நிதி ஆதரவுகளான சட்டமன்ற உறுப்பினர் நிதி, மாநாட்டி
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முறை:

சாலை மற்றும் பொக்குவாத்து	—	25%
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குப்பை மேலாண்மை	—	15%
குடிநீர் மற்றும் அழிவுநீர்	—	15%
நெரு விளக்கு	—	10%

பலகையி	-	10%
எண்முறை (பிழிபட்டல்) திரவாகம்	-	25%

____ வெற்றி வேட்பாளர் ____

வழக்கறிஞர்

வி. அனுஷா, M.Sc., B.L.

திருகர் வளர்ச்சி என்பது ஆங்கு வாழும் மக்களின் வாழ்க்கை வளர்ச்சி...

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VOORA VENTURES



Power art

The lace garlands woven by the artisans in Chintadripet take on a new character ahead of elections

R. RAGU

Artisans in Chintadripet specialising in lace garlands are going beyond the regular run-of-the-mill specifications. Even customisations through the year will fit certain patterns, monotonously recurring.

Customisations currently being pursued follow a whole new pattern. This is a pattern that repeats once every few years. These artisans are now putting faces to the lace gardens, powerful faces. Based

on orders from political parties in Tamil Nadu, they personalise the lace garlands and kritams (crowns) with the faces of leaders of those institutions.

The colours of party flags are woven into the lace garlands.

The lace garlands are qualified as sandalwood lace garlands as scented sandalwood shavings are part of what goes into their making. These wood shavings are also crafted into decorative items that jazz up the garlands. There are also lace garlands that use cardamon to

define the character of their strings.

The kritams (crowns) are made taller by artfully stacking currency notes, which is essentially about the party going the extra mile, a costly mile at that, to honour its leaders and candidates.

The makers of lace garlands are artisans with an expertise that has been passed down the generations; and their shops are found on two streets in Chintadripet, namely Ayya Street and Arunachalam Street.

These families are also part of



In Chintadripet, a shop making lace garlands and crowns is customising them currently for political parties. PHOTOS: R. RAGU

Chintadripet, youngsters taking the baton from their seniors and forbears, as is the case with Thulasi Sha with a shop on Ayya Street.

There are two sets of artisans in these two streets of Chintadripet,

one specialising in lace garlands, and other in those wide, elaborately embellished temple umbrellas. The peak season for the sale of temple umbrellas is October or the Tamil month of Puratasi.

Vocational awards presented

Rotary Club of Chennai Tower, a unit of Rotary International District 3233, organised its annual vocational service award event recently.

According to a press release, N Silambarasan, better known as "Silambam Silambu" from Ponneri was presented with Vocational Service Award - Young Achiever in Sports in recognition of his expertise in martial art, Silambam.

The Vocational Service Award - Social Service was presented to Selvakumar, a tailor from Virudhunagar. He has trained a large number of underprivileged women in tailoring with an

aim to empower them for a fee of ₹1.

S Padma, a 48-year-old conservancy worker from Chennai was presented with Vocational Service Award - Epitome of Ethics Icon for the prompt return of 45 sovereigns of gold jewellery that she discovered during her duty. The award aims to honour her exceptional honesty.

Nimal Raghavan, an engineer-turned-environmentalist, was honoured for his work on conservation of lakes. He was presented with Vocational Service Award - Environmental Preservation.

Vocational Service Award - Lifetime Achievement was presented to Bharatanatyam exponent Leela Samson, adds the release.

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‘Information on notice board is incomplete’

S. N. RAJARAM

R5 Virugambakkam Police Station on Abusali Street in Saligramam is being demolished for the construction of a new facility. The station will therefore be functioning temporarily from Venkateshwara Nagar, which is a kilometre away.

But the notice board at the demolition site informs the public about its relocation and the particulars of the new address can be known using the QR code shown in the notice board. Scanning the QR code, the user is directed to the police station at Venkateshwara Nagar through Google Maps. The tech-savvy means of communication about the new location is indeed appreciated.

However, the conventional means of communication that is the proper mention of the new address along with landmarks on the notice board will have a larger reach bridg-



ing the digital-divide.

Currently, the notice board shows just an arrow sign indicating the direction and there is no mention of Venkateshwara Nagar. This information is inadequate. In fact,

the new location is around 15 streets away. Further, the workers at the site have no idea of the new location.

S. N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam



‘Footpath around the park out of bounds’



PADMA NARASIMHAN

Greater Chennai Corporation-run Anna Park at United India Colony in Kodambakkam witnesses good patronage from local residents. This is a small park that is circular in shape and there is a footpath around it.

When there are a good number of visitors, some prefer us-

ing the footpath. But this footpath is out of bounds because it is being misused by some as a shelter.

They occupy the footpath with all their belongings.

They have their food there and litter the space.

I request Greater Chennai Corporation to do the needful.

Padma Narasimhan is a resident of Kodambakkam



WCC holds conference on environment conservation

The Centre for Environmental Studies of Women's Christian College, Nungambakkam, organised a two-day conference on titled "Zero-Waste Lifestyle: Replacing Plastics" recently.

According to a press release, a good number of students and researchers took part.

In his keynote address, R. Raman, Principal of Presidency College and Joint Director - Finance of the Directorate of Collegiate Education emphasized on integrating fis-

cal responsibility with ecological preservation in collegiate sector.

Sreya Ann Oommen, a post-doctoral fellow at the UNESCO Bridges Hub, explained the importance of imparting scientific knowledge for community-level environment conservation measures.

Non-governmental organizations Thuvakkam and Aram Thina handled the technical sessions on alternatives to single-use plastics and sustainable living, adds the press release.

Wellness clinic in T. Nagar

Samridhi Ayurveda is a clinic at New No: 13, Old No: 5/1, Jagadeshwaran Street, T. Nagar. According to a press release, it offers, treatments for ailments relating to digestion, skin, and others. Specialized therapies like Abhyangam, Shirodhara, and Panchakarma are also offered. Dr. D. Subathra, an Ayurvedic physician, is available for consultation, adds the release. The clinic is open from Monday to Sunday. Time: From 7 a.m. to 7 p.m. For details, call 98400 19001.

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Awareness drive on voting rights

Annai Velankanni's College of Arts & Science in Saidapet organised an awareness programme about the importance of exercising one's franchise in the upcoming Tamil Nadu Assembly elections. As part of the programme, students coined the slogan "My Vote My Right." Students also took a solemn pledge to exercise their voting rights.



The pink route to empowering women

On March 31, Rotary District 3234 will be distributing its second batch of pink autos to beneficiaries it has selected with a fine-tooth comb

LIFFY THOMAS

These bright pink autos have become a familiar sight on Chennai roads. Driven by women and catering primarily to women and children, pink autos are on the rise thanks to various social organisations and a scheme promoted by the Social Welfare and Women Empowerment Department of the Tamil Nadu Government to fund women (partially, in most cases) to own and drive these vehicles.

The pink fleet ticks several boxes: women empowerment, women's participation in the labour force, promoting a clean environment (CNG is used as fuel) and breaking gender stereotypes.

According to ballpark figure, Chennai must be having more than 500 pink women autorickshaw drivers and this number is only on the rise.

On March 31, Rotary District 3234 will be distributing its second batch of pink autos, close to 27 (its second major drive after it launched the project in August 2025 to distribute 100 pink autos in an event held at Chennai Trade Centre).

The District engages the service of ANEW (Association for Non-Traditional Employment for Women) to identify and train deserving women. Basics of martial arts and communication skills are also covered under the training.

"Our beneficiaries have to update us at least once a month about the status of their EMIs. So far, we have 85 who are prompt in doing that," says Siva Ilango van, chairman - Pink Auto Project, Rotary District 3234.

Supporting drivers

Rotary District 3233 initiated the Pink Auto Project in 2019 and till date has given away 153 autos for women. Rotarian Shanthi Sel-



(Right) Shanthi Selvam, chairperson of the Pink Auto Project, Rotary District 3233, with a beneficiary. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Under the project, women auto drivers train aspiring candidates. "Jothi Lakshmi, for instance, one of our first beneficiaries has trained many women, many a time spending money from her own pocket and has bought her own house with her income. Likewise, Saritha from Ashok Nagar goes to other localities to offer classes," she says.

To ensure these women have a steady income, the Club associates with various Interact and Rotract Clubs.

"Rotary Club of Madras North West is under our umbrella. We connected Selvi, residing in the area, with the Club who was put in touch with Velankanni School in Ashok Nagar that has an Interact Club. Students who needed transport now use her service," says Shanthi.

Associating with a social organisation also means these women enjoy other benefits. "Rajan Eye Hospital has tied up with us to offer free eye care for all pink auto drivers and their families, including funding their cataract surgeries," says Shanthi.

Tough rules

According to Tamil Nadu Motor Vehicle Rules, only women are authorised to operate pink autos. To be eligible to apply for an auto under the Pink Auto scheme of the State Government, a woman must be between 20 and 45 years of age. P.V. Raji Ashok, a senior auto driver from Perambur, feels having a cut-off restricts many deserving women from entering the field.

She also feels it is unfair to take action if pink autos are operated by men. "My neighbour met with an accident the day she brought the pink auto and could not drive for six months. How will she repay the loan?" she asks.

There should be some authority these women can approach to seek exception when they cannot drive for genuine reasons, says Raji, who has been an auto driver since 1998.

vam, who has been chairperson of the project since its inception, says one of the biggest success stories of the project is that none of its women beneficiaries have sold their autos despite various challenges on and off the road. That is because they follow a rigorous process in selecting the most deserving persons (single women and widows are accorded preference in the selection process) and support them till they manage a steady income. Driving these vehicles is a big step toward financial independence for these women.

Of the ₹3 lakh purchase cost of an auto run on CNG, 50 percent is

borne by the Rotary District and the rest by the beneficiary who takes a bank loan, which is to be repaid by her in instalments.

"For women whose CIBIL score does not qualify them for a loan, we arrange for the loan by tying up with a private financial institution," says Shanthi, adding that they give away pink autos as and when they find sponsors.

"Finding sponsors is a challenge, and we have not reached out for CSR funds," she says adding that these women can earn between ₹1,500 and ₹ 2,000 a day.



For women whose CIBIL score does not qualify them for a loan, we arrange for the loan by tying up with a private financial institution



The *swap* code

This has nothing to do with computer programming, but with an initiative that encourages participants to consider doing a swap on household items that might have outgrown their home but still has a place in somebody else's. Welcome to three online groups started by sustainability enthusiast and volunteer Swathi Ramanathan from Kasturba Nagar in Adyar

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Perfectly usable furniture, electronic goods, utensils and books often end up discarded because households have outgrown them. While volunteering for waste collection drives Kasturba Nagar resident Swathi Ramanathan regularly came across this anomaly and felt prompted to start two online groups, both with a WhatsApp and Telegram presence, that encourage swapping over shopping, wherever that is possible, and give gently used household items and books a new address where they are cherished all over again. In addition, following a discussion in one of these swap groups, she also formed a group where participants can learn about free wellness programmes much before they are rolled out.

Swap Don't Shop

At last count, around 1,500 residents of Chennai follow that imperative, always asking themselves whether they can swap and not shop. A WhatsApp-based initiative that spilled over to Telegram, the group enables swapping of household goods. Born on 15 July 2024 in WhatsApp, where it has hit the ceiling being packed with 1025 members, Swap Don't Shop has had to find an additional home in Telegram, where it commands the following of over 500 members. The author of the initiative, Kasturba Nagar resident Swathi Ramanathan, felt the need for this group while coordinating waste collection drives as a volunteer of Residents of Kasturba Nagar Association (ROKA). During these drives, she repeatedly noticed items still in good condition being discarded. "We saw many usable household items being thrown away. We believe a product has to be used till its lifetime comes to an end," says Swathi. Initially launched as a clothes exchange group by Swathi along with Vaishnavi Venkatesh, the platform was later expanded to include all household items after the early model failed to gain traction.

Transactions follow clear guidelines: only household items without expiry dates are allowed, and plants are welcomed. Members post photos with detailed descriptions, including brand, age, dimensions, condition, price, and pickup location. Delivery is coordinated directly between

buyer and seller, occasionally involving porters for larger items. The platform has enabled beneficiaries ranging from domestic help needing textbooks and study guides to expatriates seeking short-term household items like Golu dolls. While logistical challenges, pricing issues, and trust concerns occasionally arise, Swathi believes the initiative finds itself sustained by a sense of community and purpose felt by members.

Chennai Book Bridge

Chennai Book Bridge is a Diwali gift to those who still swear by the physical book, while also consuming information digitally. Again, the idea of starting this group occurred to Swathi during waste collection drives. She came across many people who wanted to part with their books, but only with those who will cherish those books. She decided on starting a book-swapping WhatsApp group, which has now grown to nearly 300 members, most of whom are senior citizens and regular readers who prefer physical books. Beyond book exchange and donations, the group encourages discussions on authors, genres, literary events, and book-to-film adaptations, creating an interactive reading community. Swathi notes that these discussions have become a defining feature. "It is a lovely group... there are so many things I myself didn't know about authors and books," she says.

Although a Telegram version was introduced to organise discussions by genre, participation remains stronger on WhatsApp due to the older user base. Challenges, such as reselling low-value books or managing occasional rude behaviour, are moderated with clear guidelines emphasising good faith. Swathi elaborates, "We cannot control everything, but we ensure the platform remains respectful and focused on reading."

Nalam Chennai Wellness Connect

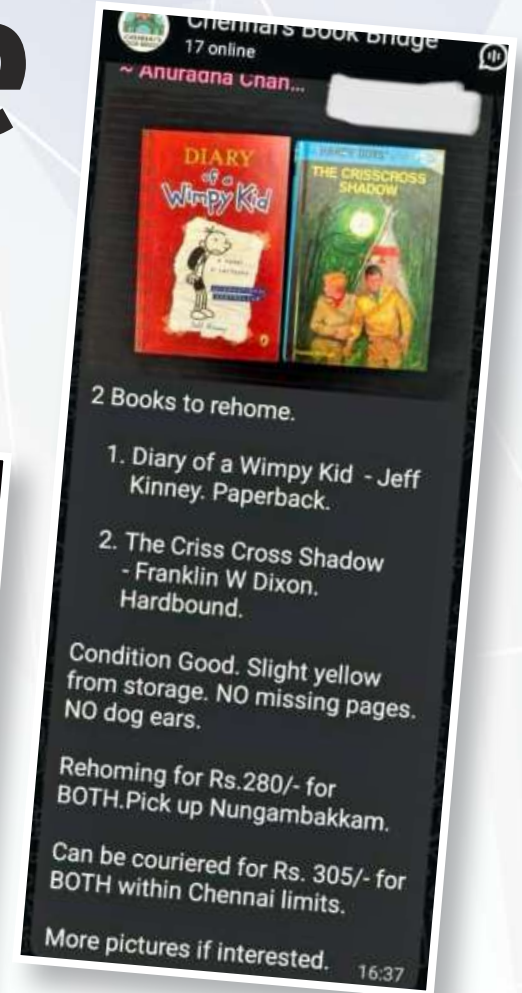
Free wellness camps have a way of eluding timely notice. Often times, they come to light as a post-event report in a website or a newspaper. Nalam Chennai Wellness Connect, present on WhatsApp and Telegram group, is an effort to bring visibility to free wellness programmes (yoga classes, health camps and so on) much before they start rolling so that people can attend and benefit from

them. Free yoga classes, free health camps

The idea began as an offshoot of the Swap Don't Shop initiative. "We wanted to brainstorm with participants about their interests. One of the interests was the wellness group. They said they wanted to know more about what was happening in the city in terms of wellness."

Members themselves can share details of free wellness services, provided the information is authentic. Swathi has shared updates on government initiatives, like free HPV vaccinations for adolescents. Currently, the group has 87 members on WhatsApp and 21 on Telegram, forming a small but growing network connecting Chennai residents to wellness opportunities that won't cost them a rupee.

For joining any of these groups, contact Swathi Ramanathan at 93812 02054



Mega career counselling fair on April 11 and 12

Conducted by
The Hindu EducationPlus,
the fair is in its
23th edition

The Hindu Education-Plus is conducting the 23rd edition of The Hindu EducationPlus Career Counselling Fair 2026 on April 11 and 12 from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m. at the Chennai Trade Centre, Convention Hall.

The exhaustive fair for parents and students from classes 9 to 12 will empower aspiring young minds to make informed career decisions from 40 plus institutions and help them choose the right courses and colleges. Top educational and financial institutions from across India will be present. Furthermore, career guidance sessions with domain experts will help people dis-

cuss their career plans.

This annual fair is a great chance for students and parents to explore different career paths, learn about college admissions, and gain insights into various fields of

study.

A plethora of options awaits students as they get ready to finish their schooling, much more than ever before. There is a wide range of courses to choose from,



REPRESENTATIONAL PICTURE

careers to aspire to, and areas of interest to delve into. In every edition, the fair has aimed to give students insights into several areas, cater to their interests, and open a world of educational opportunities for them.

The latest edition of the career Counselling fair will have all of this and make this experience possible for students by giving them the platform to engage with experts across diverse fields and representatives from various educational and financial institutions. Keeping up with the needs of the students, *The Hindu Education-*

Plus has been organising career expos to aid students looking to pursue higher education both in India and overseas.

Spot admissions and scholarships await the students at the fair along with surprise gifts for the first 200 entries on both the days. To know more about the sessions and the fair, contact: +91 90940 41021, 9962226550 and 9841298938.

"VIT Chennai presents The Hindu - Education Plus Career Counselling Fair 2026" is powered by Hindustan Group of Institutions,

Chennai and Rajalakshmi Institute of Technology, In Association with B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science & Technology. Associate partners are Amet University, Bharath Institute of Higher Education and Research, GRT Institute of Engineering and Technology, Meenakshi Academy of Higher Education & Research (MAHER), The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India, Vels Institute of Science, Technology & Advanced Studies (VISTAS) and Vinayaka Mission's Research Foundation, Chennai Campus.

To register: <https://newsth.live/THEPCFCED> or scan the QR code:



SVCE alumni awards presented



From the event.

The Alumni Association of Sri Venkateswara College of Engineering (SVCE), Sriperumbudur, hosted the second edition of its Annual Alumni Awards at Taj Wellington Mews in Chennai. The event brought together over 150 alumni from India and

abroad, reflecting the global reach of the SVCE community, says a press release.

Organised by alumni, for alumni, the Annual Alumni Awards recognises achievements across sectors.

In this edition, Lifetime Achieve-

ment Awards were presented to Air Vice Marshal R Guruhari, recipient of the Vishisht Seva Medal (2026) and Bala V. Sathyanarayanan, EVP & CHRO - Greif, USA & Board Chairman, Balmer Lawrie-Van Leer Limited.

Awards were also presented across categories including Professional Excellence, Entrepreneurship Excellence, Young Alumni, Alumni Community Builder and Nation Builder, the release adds.

"This event reflects the strength of our alumni network. We aim to bring together over 25,000 SVCE graduates," said Vijay Gnanadesikan, president of the SVCE Alumni Association.

School in T. Nagar launches new project

Bala Mandir inaugurates School Expansion & Modernisation Project at Satyamurthi Higher Secondary School Bala Mandir Kamaraj Trust today inaugurated the School Expansion & Modernisation Project at Satyamurthi Higher Secondary School, located at the Bala Mandir campus at No 1, Giriappa Road, (Opposite to Bala Mandir Main Gate) in T. Nagar, Chennai. The project marks an important milestone in the institution's efforts to provide quality and holistic education to children from disadvan-



tagged backgrounds as well as the surrounding community.

The inauguration was held in the presence of Guests of Honour, Ms. Praveena Yagnambhat, Chief of Staff & CSR Head, Boeing India and

South Asia; Mr. K.G. Venkataraman, Chief Financial Officer, Saint-Gobain India Private Limited (SGIPL); and Ms. Maya Gaitonde, Honorary General Secretary & Trustee, Bala Mandir Kamaraj Trust.

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